

# Day 5 — Lunar Months and Festivals

**Module:** Moon Phases and Tithi · **Band:** Senior · **Time:** 45 min

## Learning objective

By the end of this lesson, students will: map the 12 lunar months (caitra, vaiśākha, ...) to major festivals.

## Materials

- Whiteboard / chart paper
- Notebook, pen per student
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

## Vocabulary introduced today

- *tithi* (IAST: tithi; lit. “lunar day (1/30 of synodic month)”)

## Lesson flow

### Warm-up (5 min)

- Daily check-in: one-sentence response to “*What’s one thing you remember about yesterday’s lesson?*”
- Hook: introduce a phenomenon or question that motivates today’s concept.

### Core (20 min)

1. **Twelve lunar months.** *Caitra, Vaiśākha, Jyaiṣṭha, Āṣāḍha, Śrāvaṇa, Bhādrapada, Āśvina, Kārtika, Mārgaśīrṣa (Agrahāyaṇa), Pauṣa, Māgha, Phālguna*. Each begins on a new moon (*pūrṇimānta* tradition — North India) OR the day after the previous full moon (*amānta* tradition — South India). Both reference the same lunar month with a 15-day phase difference.
2. **Source.** Varāhamihira’s *Bṛhat Saṃhitā* discusses both reckonings; the Sūrya-siddhānta uses *amānta*.
3. **Festivals by tithi.** Examples:
  - *Diwali* — *Kṛṣṇa amāvasyā* of Kārtika
  - *Holi* — *Pūrṇimā* of Phālguna (followed by *Vasantotsava*)
  - *Janmāṣṭamī* — *Kṛṣṇa aṣṭamī* of Śrāvaṇa
  - *Mahā-Śivarātri* — *Kṛṣṇa caturdaśī* of Māgha
4. **Class mapping.** Hand out cards with festival names. Students place each on a 12-month wheel, noting tithi + pakṣa. Compare two regions’ festival calendars.

5. **Honest history.** Not all festivals are pan-Indian. Some are regional (Onam — Malayalam solar calendar; Pongal — Tamil solar calendar). Distinguish lunisolar tradition from purely solar reckonings.

### Activity (15 min)

A scaled version of *10-Day Moon Observation Diary* (see [activities/](#)). Today's slice: focus on the part of the activity that reinforces Lunar Months and Festivals.

### Wrap-up (5 min)

- One-sentence exit ticket: “*What’s one thing you learned today?*”
- Preview tomorrow.

### Homework

(See [homework.md](#) for today’s task.)

### Differentiation

- **Extension:** offer one open question or extra problem for fast finishers.
- **Support:** pair students who need scaffolds; offer partial outlines.

### Teacher notes

- Citations: at least one quoted verse with citation per module. Day 1 already includes one if applicable; you may add more.
- Connect to prior modules where natural (especially Module 2 *pañcabhūta*).